

Face-2-Face with Employer

“It’s extremely satisfying to work on something and watch the world use it. For example, when I joined Intel 17 years ago we were working on the Pentium Pro. Today there are 200 million of them being used all over the world.”

Rohit Vidwans
Director
Digital Enterprise Group
Intel

Examples of Employers

Infotech	GE
Intel	HCL
Cisco	IBM

one shouldn’t be swayed by the current outlook — the industry has always bounced back from recessionary periods with renewed avenues for growth.

Currently the industry is looking at alternative energy and MEEMS (Micro Electronics Electromechanical), as used in, for example the Nintendo Wii, as the new growth areas.

Over all there is great potential for chip design. There is a demand for chips in every sector, be it automobiles, consumer electronics or high-end servers. There is a constant need for more chips. Rohit says he doesn’t see a problem for every engineer coming out of the engineering schools wants to make a career in chip design, in getting a job. Companies like Intel, IBM and Cisco have all set up operations in India and are always looking out for fresh talent.

Sample Job Description

Lead - WiFi

- Strong experience and expertise on 802.11 a/b/g protocols
- Should have worked on solutions around this technology
- Design and development experience with specific LLC and MAC layer protocols
- Complete understanding of the overall system, interactions among various modules and blocks in the system
- Familiarity with test frameworks for these protocols
- Working experience with standard body forums and communities
- Should be able to understand the wireless technology landscape, have understanding of current limitations and challenges
- Need to interact with clients in understanding the requirements and should be able to architect solutions

Lead - WiMAX

- Well versed with 802.16d/e technologies
- Development experience with MAC layer/data link layer
- Awareness to various WiMAX Network Interfaces, their Design and development nuances
- Interaction with WiMax forums an added advantage
- Understanding technologies for Multi-Service Networks, Mobility Management Procedures
- Complete understanding of the overall system, interactions among various modules/blocks in the system
- Familiarity with Test frameworks for these protocols
- Working experience with standard body forums and communities

Required Mind Set

Ability to deal with a level of abstraction: the science and craft of design is evolving and becoming more complex. Practitioners need to hone their skills over the years.

Get a kick out of technology: chips are at the root of a lot of product innovations taking

place. Given the amount of effort and time involved in getting to the final product, a person should inherently be in love with technology to keep him going.

Patience: it takes over a year and a half before freshers can start contributing productively to various projects. So don’t lose heart too soon.